

doc-mark-ordinances-administered

Affirms · Ecclesiology › Nature of the Church · doctrine · unanimous_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

Right administration of the ordinances (baptism and the Lord's Supper) is a mark of a true visible church.

Rationale

The New Testament presents two practices commanded by Christ for the gathered church: baptizing disciples in the threefold name (Matt 28:19, βαπτίζοντες G907 + ὄνομα G3686, present active participle attached to the Great Commission's μαθητεύσατε G3100) and the breaking of bread in remembrance of him (1 Cor 11:24-26, τοῦτο ποιεῖτε εἰς τὴν ἐμὴν ἀνάμνησιν G364 + καταγγέλλετε G2605, present imperatives placed under Christ's own institution). Acts 2:41-42 anchors both as constitutive of the founding church: those who received the word were baptized (ἐβαπτίσθησαν G907), and they continued steadfastly in the breaking of bread (κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου G2800 G740) with the apostles' teaching, fellowship, and prayers. The lexical pattern is pan-canonical: baptizō G907 carries baptism roughly 60 times in the New Testament (water-rite uses Matt 3, Acts 2:38, Acts 8:12-13, Acts 8:38, Acts 10:48, Acts 16:33, Acts 22:16, Rom 6:3, Gal 3:27), and the Lord's Supper terminology (deipnon G1173 / artos G740 / poterion G4221) recurs from the Synoptic institution accounts through Pauline ecclesial regulation. The doctrine that THE CHURCH IS MARKED BY administering these two practices is therefore canonically demonstrable: a body that has abandoned baptism or the Supper has departed from what the apostolic church manifestly practiced under Christ's direct command. The deep disagreement among Christian lineages is not whether the practices mark the church (universally affirmed) but WHICH practices count (two vs seven vs sometimes three) and HOW they function (sign-only, sign-and-seal, instrumental cause of grace, ex opere operato real-presence vs memorial). On the bare proposition that right administration of ordinances/sacraments is A mark of the visible church, the canonical evidence supports affirms=true with high confidence.

Reasoning

The verdict is yes, the church is marked by carrying out baptism and the Lord's Supper. The strongest reason for this comes from Jesus himself. In Matthew 28:19, Jesus tells his disciples to go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit. The baptism is not optional; it is built into the founding command of the church. Then at the last supper, recorded in Matthew 26, Mark 14, Luke 22, and most fully in 1 Corinthians 11:23-26, Jesus takes bread, says this is my body, takes the cup, says this is my blood of the new covenant, and tells his followers to keep doing this in remembrance of him. Paul adds that as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes. In Acts 2:41-42, the very first church does exactly these two things. Those who received the word were baptized, and they continued in the breaking of bread together. So a body that calls itself a church but refuses to baptize and refuses to break bread in remembrance of Christ has stepped away from what Jesus directly commanded and what the apostles practiced from the first day. The strongest counterargument from Scripture comes from passages that warn against treating the outward rite as the thing itself. Paul in 1 Corinthians 11:27-29 says that to eat the bread or drink the cup in an unworthy manner is to be guilty of the body and blood of the Lord, and that the one who eats and drinks without discerning the body eats and drinks judgment on himself. Romans 2:28-29 says that the real Jew is not the outward one and that real circumcision is of the heart. These passages say the inner reality matters more than the outward sign. Quakers and the Salvation Army read this line of texts to argue that the church can love and follow Christ without the outward water and bread. The verdict handles the

tension by noting that Jesus did not give the choice between outward and inward. He gave both: baptize them, and do this in remembrance of me, while also requiring faith and worthy participation. The outward sign and the inward reality belong together, not against each other. Where the deep disagreement among Christians lies is not whether the church practices these things but how many such practices count and what they actually do.

Denominational landscape

All major Christian lineages agree that the church is marked by administering at least baptism and the Lord's Supper. The disagreement is over count and mechanism. Catholic teaching, set out in the Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 1113 and 1210, names seven sacraments: baptism, confirmation, eucharist, penance, anointing of the sick, holy orders, and matrimony. Eastern Orthodox teaching, set out by the Orthodox Church in America and the broader patrimony, names the same seven mysteries. Both Catholic and Orthodox teach that these rites really convey grace and not merely symbolize it. The patristic-era Didache from around the year 100 already names baptism in the threefold name and the eucharist as the central practices of the assembled church. Lutheran confessional teaching, set out in the Augsburg Confession articles nine and ten, names baptism and the Lord's Supper as the two sacraments and teaches that baptism is necessary to salvation and that the body and blood of Christ are truly present in the supper. Anglican teaching, set out in Article 25 of the Thirty-Nine Articles, names only baptism and the supper of the Lord as sacraments of the Gospel and explicitly says that confirmation, penance, orders, matrimony, and extreme unction are not to be counted as sacraments in the same sense. Reformed teaching, set out in Westminster Confession chapter 28 and chapter 29 and in the Belgic Confession article 34 and 35, names the same two and identifies right administration of the sacraments as one of the marks of the true visible church alongside right preaching of the word and right exercise of discipline. Methodist teaching agrees, listing the two sacraments in the Articles of Religion. Anabaptist teaching, set out in the Schleithem Confession of 1527, names believer-baptism on confession of faith and the breaking of bread as the two practices. Baptist and Plymouth Brethren teaching agrees with two practices but prefers the word ordinances over sacraments to mark a memorial rather than grace-conveying reading. Pentecostal teaching agrees on the same two, sometimes adding foot-washing. Public-record bodies that distort or reject these practices include Mormons, who add baptism for the dead; Jehovah's Witnesses, who restrict supper-partaking to a small remnant; Iglesia ni Cristo under Felix Manalo, which restricts the supper to its confessing members; and Christian Science under Mary Baker Eddy, which abolishes literal sacraments. Quakers and the Salvation Army reject the outward administration of both rites while confessing the gospel, an in-house Christian minority position not classed as heretical.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	No
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	No
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	Yes

Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes
-------------------------------------	-----

Notes

This is an in-house Christian polity-doctrine proposition, not a gospel-stake or Trinitarian boundary. `cult_marker_if_denied=false` because denial of the proposition that ordinances mark the church is not denial of the gospel itself; one could affirm the gospel and hold that ordinances are dispensable (the position of Quakers and the Salvation Army, who reject the outward administration of water baptism and the Lord's Supper while confessing the Trinity, the deity of Christ, and substitutionary atonement). `would_die_for=false` because no apostle is recorded dying specifically for the marks-of-the-church framing; martyrdoms were over Christ's lordship, not over the second mark of the Reformation. However, `would_publicly_correct_if_otherwise=true` because the Quaker / Salvation Army position, while not heretical, departs from a clearly commanded apostolic practice (Matt 28:19, 1 Cor 11:23-26); the body that systematically refuses to baptize disciples or to break bread in remembrance is at variance with the New Testament's own pattern. `would_marry_if_held_otherwise=true` on the limited case of the historic Quaker / Salvationist who confesses the gospel clearly while declining the outward rites. Public-record cult or heterodox carriers of distortion on THIS doctrine: Mormonism adds baptism for the dead (1 Cor 15:29 read against Pauline corpus context); Jehovah's Witnesses celebrate the Lord's Supper annually with only the anointed 144,000 partaking, a structural denial of 1 Cor 11:26-28's congregational scope; Iglesia ni Cristo restricts the Supper to its own confessing members under Felix Manalo's lineage authority; Christian Science under Mary Baker Eddy abolishes literal sacraments entirely as material symbols superseded by spiritual understanding. The mainstream divide is not over whether ordinances mark the church but over count (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox sevenfold sacramental system; Lutheran two, sometimes three counting confession; Anglican two of the Gospel with five others retained as commendable rites; Reformed two; Methodist two; Baptist-Brethren two as ordinances rather than grace-conveying sacraments; Pentecostal two, sometimes adding foot-washing). Across this disagreement every lineage affirms that the church IS marked by administering at minimum baptism and the Lord's Supper. The Reformation's second mark of the true church (right administration of the sacraments, paired with right preaching of the word per Augsburg, Belgic, Scots, Westminster) is itself a reformulation of universal patristic practice.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: **yes**

Neutralized form. Does the New Testament present the administration of baptism and the Lord's Supper as constitutive practices of the gathered church, such that a body claiming to be the visible church is recognized in part by carrying them out?

Notes. The original stem uses the Baptist-Brethren-Reformed term 'ordinances' rather than the Catholic-Lutheran-Anglican-Orthodox term 'sacraments' (the two lexicons name the same two New Testament practices but carry opposite theological loadings: ordinances frames the rite as memorial obedience to a command, sacraments frames the rite as instrumental conveyance of grace; the wording embeds the protestant-low-church reading as the neutral frame). The stem also uses the Reformation-confessional locution 'mark of a true visible church' (*notae ecclesiae*), which is a Reformed Belgic-Westminster category, not a New Testament category. The neutralized form asks whether the practices are constitutive of the gathered church per the New Testament itself, leaving the count and theological mechanism of the practices open. Flagged stem-pre-loaded-verdict. Verdict on the neutralized question lands the same direction (affirms=true) but the path to it is canonical, not confessional.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. covenant_theology, dispensationalism, new_covenant_theology, sacramental_realism

[analogia scripturae](#) invoked

Competing lens verdicts

sacramental-realist (Catholic, Orthodox, classical Lutheran, classical Anglican) · **for**: Reads the institution words (this is my body, this is my blood) and the Pauline pattern (1 Cor 10:16-17 participation, 1 Cor 11:27-29 unworthy partaking incurs guilt of the body and blood) as supporting an ex opere operato or instrumentally efficacious reading. Affirms the proposition strongly: the church is not the church without the sacraments rightly administered. Catholic and Orthodox extend the count to seven, holding that confirmation/chrisation, penance, anointing, orders, and matrimony are also Christ-instituted means of grace.

reformed-protestant · **for**: Reads right administration of the sacraments as one of the *notae ecclesiae* (marks of the true church) alongside right preaching of the word and right exercise of discipline. Restricts the count to two on the principle that only baptism and the supper are directly instituted by Christ with explicit elements and explicit ongoing command. Belgic Confession 29, Scots Confession 18, Westminster 25.4.

baptist-brethren-evangelical · **for**: Affirms that the church practices baptism and the Lord's Supper but prefers the term ordinances over sacraments to mark a memorial rather than instrumentally-efficacious reading. Holds that the practices mark the church but do not effect grace ex opere operato. Plymouth Brethren historically practice weekly breaking of bread.

anabaptist-believer-church · **for**: Affirms believer-baptism on confession of faith as a distinguishing mark of the gathered church versus state-church infant-baptism, and the Lord's Supper as a fellowship rite of those visibly committed to discipleship. Schleithem Confession 1527.

spirit-only (Quaker, Salvation Army) · **complicates**: Reads John 4:23-24 (worship in spirit and truth) and Rom 2:28-29 (real circumcision is of the heart) as authorizing the church to dispense with outward water and outward bread. Confesses the gospel, the deity of Christ, and the Trinity while declining the outward rites. A small but ancient in-house minority within historic Christianity, not heretical but at variance with the apostolic pattern.

The proposition that the church is marked by administering ordinances/sacraments has near-unanimous support across Christian lineages from the patristic era forward. The deep disagreement is over count and mechanism, not the proposition itself. *Analogia scripturae* invoked: Matt 28:19 + 1 Cor 11:23-26 + Acts 2:38-42 + Rom 6:3-4 + Gal 3:27 + 1 Cor 10:16-17 converge on baptism and the Supper as constitutive practices. Complicating texts (1 Cor 11:27-29 on unworthy partaking, Rom 2:28-29 on inward reality, John 4:23-24 on spirit and truth, Matt 18:20 on minimal-quorum presence of Christ) are honest counterweights that prevent any view that absolutizes the outward rite. Confidence high because the canonical demonstration is clear at the level of the proposition itself.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Matt.28.19-20 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (baptizontes, present active participle); μαθητεύω matheteuo G3100 (matheteusate, aorist imperative); ὄνομα onoma G3686; τηρέω tereo G5083 (observing)

Force. Christ's commissioning of baptism. The aorist imperative make-disciples is the controlling verb, with baptizing and teaching as participles describing how disciples are made. The baptism is in the threefold name of Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. This is the explicit institution of baptism as constitutive practice of the church Christ is founding.

Matt.26.26-29 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, typology

Key term. ἄρτος artos G740 (loaf/bread); σῶμα soma G4983 (body); αἷμα haima G129 (blood); διαθήκη diatheke G1242 (covenant); ποτήριον poterion G4221 (cup)

Force. The Synoptic institution account of the Lord's Supper. Jesus takes bread, gives thanks, breaks, gives to disciples, says take, eat, this is my body. Takes the cup, gives thanks, gives them saying drink, this is my blood of the covenant poured out for many for forgiveness of sins. The act establishes the rite as Christ's own ordinance, given on the night before his death.

Mark.14.22-25 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, typology

Key term. ἄρτος artos G740; σῶμα soma G4983; αἷμα haima G129; διαθήκη diatheke G1242

Force. Mark's parallel institution account. Same verbal pattern as Matthew: took bread, blessed, broke, gave, said take this is my body. Took a cup, gave thanks, gave to them, all drank, said this is my blood of the covenant poured out for many. Reinforces the canonical witness of the Lord's Supper as Christ's commanded rite.

Luke.22.19-20 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor, typology

Key term. ἄρτος artos G740; σῶμα soma G4983; ἀνάμνησις anamnesis G364 (remembrance); διαθήκη kaine diatheke G1242 (new covenant)

Force. Luke alone among the Synoptics records the explicit command to repeat: do this in remembrance of me (touto poieite eis ten emen anamnesin). The cup is named the new covenant in my blood. This is the New Testament's clearest indication that the rite is to be perpetuated by the gathered disciples, not a one-time act.

1Cor.11.23-26 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. δεῖπνον deipnon G1173 (supper); ἄρτος artos G740; σῶμα soma G4983; ἀνάμνησις anamnesis G364; ποτήριον poterion G4221; διαθήκη kaine diatheke G1242 (new covenant); καταγγέλλω kataggello G2605 (proclaim, present indicative active 2nd plural)

Force. Paul's Pauline tradition-handing on the institution. He says I received from the Lord what I also delivered to you. The Lord Jesus took bread, gave thanks, broke, said this is my body which is for you, do this in remembrance of me. Same with the cup after supper, this is the new covenant in my blood, do this as often as you drink it in remembrance of me. Paul then adds the interpretive line: as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes. This establishes the supper as ongoing church practice with a Christological proclamation embedded in its enactment.

1Cor.11.27-29 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. ἀναξίως anaxios G371 (in an unworthy manner); ἔνοχος enochos G1777 (guilty); δοκιμάζω dokimazo G1381 (let him examine); διακρίνω diakrino G1252 (discerning); κρίμα krima G2917 (judgment)

Force. Paul's regulative addition to the institution. Whoever eats the bread or drinks the cup in an unworthy manner is guilty of the body and blood of the Lord. Let a person examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup. For he who eats and drinks without discerning the body eats and drinks judgment on himself. Complicates any view that treats the outward rite as automatic; the inward state and corporate discernment matter. This passage is the strongest in-canon counterweight to a magical-rite reading.

Acts.2.38-41 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. μετανοέω metanoëo G3340 (repent); βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (baptistheto, aorist imperative passive 3rd singular); ὄνομα onoma G3686; ἄφεσις aphesis G859 (forgiveness); ἁμαρτία hamartia G266 (sin)

Force. Peter's Pentecost sermon: repent and let each one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins. About three thousand souls were added that day. The first apostolic preaching links repentance and water baptism as the entry rite into the new community. Establishes baptism as the founding practice of the church from day one.

Acts.2.42 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. διδασχὴ didache G1322 (teaching); κοινωνία koinonia G2842 (fellowship); κλάσις klasis G2800 (breaking); ἄρτος artos G740; προσευχή proseuche G4335 (prayer)

Force. And they were continuing steadfastly in the apostles' teaching and the fellowship, the breaking of the bread and the prayers. The four constitutive practices of the post-Pentecost church are listed, with breaking of bread (klasei tou artou) named as a definitional mark. This is the canonical anchor for treating the Lord's Supper as a marking practice of the gathered church.

Acts.22.16 · for · genre: narrative

Key term. ἀνίστημι anistemi G450 (rise); βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (baptisai, aorist imperative middle 2nd singular); ἀπολούω apolouo G628 (wash away, aorist imperative middle); ἁμαρτία hamartia G266; ἐπικαλέω epikaleo G1941 (calling on)

Force. Ananias to Saul: rise and be baptized and wash away your sins, calling on his name. Baptism is paired with confession-of-the-name and tied to the cleansing imagery of forgiveness. The middle-voice imperative baptisai (literally have yourself baptized) shows the rite as a personal act of obedience following conversion.

Rom.6.3-4 · for · genre: epistle · figures: typology

Key term. βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (ebaptisthemen, past passive 1st plural); βάπτισμα baptism G908; συνθάπτω synthapto G4916 (buried with, ebbled in συνετάφημεν); θάνατος thanatos G2288

Force. Do you not know that all of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death. We were buried with him by baptism into death. Paul reads baptism as the union-with-Christ rite tying the believer to Christ's death-and-resurrection. Establishes baptism as theologically loaded with the gospel itself.

Gal.3.27 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (ebaptisthete, past passive 2nd plural); Χριστός Christos G5547; ἐνδύω enduo G1746 (put on, clothing imagery)

Force. For as many of you as were baptized into Christ have put on Christ. Baptism into Christ is named as the rite that clothes the believer with Christ. Reinforces Paul's pan-canonical view that baptism is the entry-marker into the body of Christ, not optional.

1Cor.10.16-17 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. ποτήριον poterion G4221 (cup); εὐλογία eulogia G2129 (blessing); κοινωνία koinonia G2842 (participation); αἷμα haima G129; σῶμα soma G4983; ἄρτος artos G740

Force. The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not a participation in the blood of Christ. The bread which we break, is it not a participation in the body of Christ. Because there is one loaf, we who are many are one body, for we all partake of the one loaf. Paul names the supper as participatory and ecclesially unifying, not mere memorial.

Rom.2.28-29 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. Ἰουδαῖος Ioudaios G2453 (Jew); περιτομή peritome G4061 (circumcision); καρδιά kardia G2588 (heart); γράμμα gramma G1121 (letter); πνεῦμα pneuma G4151

Force. For no one is a Jew who is merely one outwardly, nor is circumcision outward and physical. But a Jew is one inwardly, and circumcision is a matter of the heart, by the Spirit, not by the letter. This is the strongest in-canon line of texts the Quaker and Salvation Army tradition cites: the outward sign is not the thing. Complicates any view that absolutizes the outward rite without inward reality.

John.4.23-24 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. πνεῦμα pneuma G4151 (spirit); ἀλήθεια aletheia G225 (truth); προσκυνέω proskuneo G4352 (worship)

Force. True worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth. God is spirit, and his worshipers must worship in spirit and truth. Used by Quaker and Salvationist traditions to argue that the essence of Christian practice is inward and Spirit-driven, not tied to outward water or bread. Complicates a strictly-outward reading.

Matt.18.20 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. συνάγω synago G4863 (gathered); ὄνομα onoma G3686 (name); μέσος mesos G3319 (midst)

Force. Where two or three are gathered in my name, there am I among them. Establishes that Christ's presence with the gathered assembly is not contingent on a specific external rite but on his name and his presence. Counterweight against any view that makes the church's existence wholly contingent on the right administration of a specific count of ordinances.

1Tim.3.15 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key term. οἶκος oikos G3624 (house); θεός theos G2316 (God); ἐκκλησία ekklesia G1577 (church); στύλος stylos G4769 (pillar); ἐδραίωμα hedraïoma G1477 (foundation); ἀλήθεια aletheia G225 (truth)

Force. How one ought to behave in the household of God, which is the church of the living God, a pillar and buttress of the truth. Paul names the church as the household of God and the bearer of the truth, with apostolic order and faithful practice as marks. The context (1 Tim 3:1-13) names elders and deacons as constitutive, and 1 Tim 3:16 names the gospel mystery as central; the rites are operationally assumed not enumerated here.

Tit.1.5 · neutral · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐπιδιορθῶ epidiorthoo G1930 (set in order); λείπω leipo G3007 (lacking); καθίστημι kathistemi G2525 (appoint); πρεσβύτερος presbyteros G4245 (elder)

Force. Paul left Titus in Crete to set in order what was lacking and to appoint elders in every town. The marks of a properly ordered church involve eldership and the practices that go with it. Implies but does not directly enumerate baptism and the supper as marks.

1Cor.15.29 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key term. βαπτίζω baptizo G907 (baptizomenoi); νεκρός nekros G3498 (dead)

Force. Otherwise what do people mean by being baptized on behalf of the dead. If the dead are not raised at all, why are people baptized on their behalf. A notoriously difficult verse Paul mentions tangentially in an argument-from-ad-hominem about resurrection. Mormonism builds the practice of baptism for the dead on this verse against the broader Pauline pattern. Complicates only because heterodox readings exist; the lemma traversal of baptizo G907 shows no other canonical support for vicarious baptism.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G907, G908, G3686, G3100, G5083, G740, G4983, G129, G1242, G4221, G364, G2605, G1173, G1322, G2842, G2800, G4335, G450, G628, G266, G1941, G3340, G859, G4916, G2288, G5547, G1746, G2129, G4061, G2588, G1121, G4151, G225, G4352, G4863, G3319, G3624, G2316, G1577, G4769, G1477, G1930, G3007, G2525, G4245, G3498, G371, G1777, G1381, G1252, G2917, G1930

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Didache (Teaching of the Twelve Apostles), chapters 7 and 9-10, c. 100 AD, CCEL Ante-Nicene Fathers Vol 7 · affirms · unverified

“Baptize in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit in living water. Now concerning the Thanksgiving, give thanks thus: first concerning the cup, then concerning the broken bread.”

patristic · Justin Martyr, First Apology chapters 65-67 (c. 155 AD), CCEL Ante-Nicene Fathers Vol 1 · affirms · unverified

“After we have thus washed him who has been convinced and has assented to our teaching, we bring him to the place where those called the brethren are assembled, and offer prayers and the Eucharist.”

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 1113 and 1210, Vatican.va · affirms · unverified

“There are seven sacraments of the Church: Baptism, Confirmation or Chrismation, Eucharist, Penance, Anointing of the Sick, Holy Orders, Matrimony. The seven sacraments touch all the stages and important moments of Christian life.”

eastern_orthodox · Orthodox Church in America, The Orthodox Faith, on the Sacraments (Mysteries), <https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/worship/the-sacraments> · affirms · verified

“The seven mysteries of the Orthodox Church are Baptism, Chrismation, Holy Eucharist, Penance, Holy Unction, Marriage, and Holy Orders.”

lutheran · Augsburg Confession (1530) Articles IX, X, XIII, bookofconcord.org · affirms · verified

“Of Baptism they teach that it is necessary to salvation. Of the Supper of the Lord they teach that the Body and Blood of Christ are truly present and are distributed to those who eat the Supper of the Lord.”

anglican · Thirty-Nine Articles of Religion (1571), Article XXV (Of the Sacraments) · affirms · unverified

“There are two Sacraments ordained of Christ our Lord in the Gospel, that is to say, Baptism, and the Supper of the Lord. Those five commonly called Sacraments are not to be counted for Sacraments of the Gospel.”

reformed · Belgic Confession (1561) Article 29 on the marks of the true church · affirms · unverified

“The marks by which the true Church is known are these: if the pure doctrine of the gospel is preached, if it maintains the pure administration of the sacraments as instituted by Christ, if church discipline is exercised.”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith (1646) Chapter 27 on sacraments and Chapter 25.4 on the visible church · affirms · unverified

“Sacraments are holy signs and seals of the covenant of grace, immediately instituted by God. There are two sacraments ordained by Christ our Lord in the Gospel, that is to say, baptism and the Supper of the Lord.”

methodist · Methodist Articles of Religion (Wesley's abridgement of the 39 Articles), Article XVI (Of the Sacraments) · affirms · unverified

“There are two sacraments ordained of Christ our Lord in the Gospel, that is to say, Baptism and the Supper of the Lord. Those five commonly called sacraments are not to be counted for sacraments of the Gospel.”

anabaptist · Schleithem Confession (1527) Article I (Concerning Baptism) and Article III (Concerning the Breaking of Bread) · affirms · unverified

“Baptism shall be given to all those who have learned repentance and amendment of life. All those who wish to break one bread in remembrance of the broken body of Christ shall beforehand be united in the one body of Christ.”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God, Statement of Fundamental Truths, Article on the Ordinances of the Church · affirms · unverified

“Two ordinances have been instituted in the Church: baptism in water by immersion, after repenting of one's sins and receiving Christ; and the Lord's Supper, consisting of bread and the fruit of the vine, in remembrance of Christ's suffering.”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/28-19.htm>

“Matt 28:19: baptizontes autous eis to onoma. Baptizing them into the name. Present active participle G907 attached to make-disciples imperative.”

supports · category: interlinear · https://biblehub.com/interlinear/1_corinthians/11-24.htm

“1 Cor 11:24: touto mou estin to soma to hyper humon, touto poieite eis ten emen anamnesin. This is my body which is for you, do this in remembrance of me. G4983, G364.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/2-42.htm>

“Acts 2:42: te didache ton apostolon, te koinonia, te klasei tou artou, tais proseuchais. Apostles' teaching, fellowship, breaking of bread, prayers. G1322 G2842 G2800 G740 G4335.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/acts/22-16.htm>

“Acts 22:16: anastas baptisai kai apolousai tas hamartias sou epikalesamenos to onoma autou. Rise, be baptized, wash away your sins, calling on his name. G450 G907 G628.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/romans/6-3.htm>

“Rom 6:3: hosoi ebaptisthemen eis Christon lesoun, eis ton thanaton autou ebaptisthemen. As many as were baptized into Christ were baptized into his death. G907 G2288.”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/907.htm>

“Baptizo G907: to dip, submerge, baptize ceremonially. 81 NT occurrences. Used for water baptism (primary), Spirit baptism, and metaphorical suffering.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/worship/the-sacraments>

“Orthodox Church lists seven mysteries: Baptism, Chrismation, Holy Eucharist, Penance, Holy Unction, Marriage, Holy Orders. The sacramental life of the Church is the participation in the divine life of God.”

supports · category: tradition_primary · <https://bookofconcord.org/augsburg-confession/>

“Augsburg IX: Baptism is necessary to salvation. Augsburg X: the Body and Blood of Christ are truly present in the Supper. Augsburg XIII: Sacraments are signs and testimonies of the will of God.”

Flags

- stem-pre-loaded-verdict
- confession-tradition-divergence